

A *programming language* is a set of rules for giving instructions to a computer. It provides the syntax for giving instructions and specifies the ways to store information, and it controls the order in which instructions are executed in a program.

Python is a *high-level programming language*, which means it takes care of many low-level tasks for you so you can focus on solving problems. For example, when you assign a value to a variable, Python deletes the variable automatically when it's no longer needed, sparing you from having to manage memory.

Every language has unique features that lead to characteristic programming styles and philosophies. Python focuses on simplicity, readability, and getting the job done.